

Fig

*Fig roots go deeper than any other tree,
to find water far underground.*



If you open up a fig you will see it is filled with many tiny packets of juicy pulp. What you are holding is not a single piece of fruit, but many fruits in the same skin. Each little bead contains a seed made by a different flower. For this reason figs are known as “multiple fruits” — pineapples are like this, too.

Inside an unripe fig are lots of little flowers waiting in the dark. What for? A micro-wasp, just 2 mm (0.08 in) long. She squeezes inside to lay her eggs in safety. As she crawls around she pollinates the flowers. Some of her young leave the fig before it ripens, but the rest are eaten by the fig!

